

THE BIG BANG THEORY

REVISED PILOT

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FIRST DRAFT
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COLD OPENING / A

FADE IN:

INT. FERTILITY CLINIC WAITING ROOM - DAY (DAY 1)
(Leonard, Sheldon, Althea, Extras)

WE OPEN ON LEONARD, A POST-DOCTORAL THEORETICAL PHYSICIST, AN ACTUAL GENIUS -- HIS IQ IS OFF THE CHARTS. HE SITS IMPATIENTLY FOR A BEAT, SEES A RUBIK'S CUBE ON THE TABLE, PICKS IT UP AND SOLVES IT IN A FEW DEFT MOVES. HIS FRIEND AND ROOMMATE, SHELDON, ALSO A VERIFIABLE GENIUS WITH SIMILAR CREDENTIALS, EMERGES THROUGH A DOOR.

LEONARD

Took you long enough.

SHELDON

If you had any inkling of what I've
just been through I think you'd be a
little more sympathetic.

LEONARD

What could you have been through? You
went in there to make a sperm deposit.

SHELDON

Leonard, think about it. We're
selling our sperm to a high IQ sperm
bank, but we can't guarantee high IQ
offspring. Extreme intelligence is as
much of a mutation as the migrating
eye of the flounder.

LEONARD

And this came to you while you were...
pleasuring yourself?

SHELDON

Yes.

LEONARD

Did you see they had movies in there?

SHELDON

I couldn't stop thinking we were
committing fraud. Some poor woman is
going to pin her hopes on my sperm.
What if she winds up with a toddler
who doesn't know if he should use an
integral or a differential to solve
for the area under a curve.

LEONARD

I'm sure she'll still love him.

SHELDON

I wouldn't.

LEONARD

Sheldon, did you fill the cup or not?

SHELDON

Oh, I don't think the cups are
designed to be filled. The size is
meant to facilitate aim, like the
spittoons of the Old West.

LEONARD
Did you or didn't you?

SHELDON
Oh, yes. Eventually. For the record,
I have tennis elbow and I'm chafed.

LEONARD
Come on.

THEY CROSS TO THE COUNTER WHERE A RATHER BORED WOMAN, ALTHEA,
SITS BEHIND THE COUNTER WORKING A CROSSWORD PUZZLE. SHE
DOESN'T LOOK UP.

LEONARD (CONT'D)
Excuse me.

ALTHEA
(INTENT ON THE PUZZLE) Hang on.

LEONARD
One across is "Aegean." Eight down is
"Nabokov," twenty-six across is "MCM,"
thirteen down is - move your finger -
"phylum," which makes thirteen
across... Port-au-Prince. (OFF HER
UNHAPPY LOOK) Ta-da!

ALTHEA
Can I help you?

LEONARD
Yes, we've made two deposits. That's
about eighty million egg-seeking
geniuses.

SHELDON
Potential geniuses. I have a sister
with the same basic DNA mix who
hostesses at Fuddrucker's.

ALTHEA
I'll get you your checks.

SHELDON
Hold on, please. (TO LEONARD) I
can't take the money. It's not right.

LEONARD
(TO ALTHEA) Can you give us a minute?
He's having a crisis of conscience.
I'm sure you get this all the time.

ALTHEA
Not really. Most of the fellas pretty
much come and go.

LEONARD
(TO SHELDON) This was your idea. A
little extra spending money and we
pick up the eight-inch Celestron
telescope with the digital star finder
and the altazimuth mount.

SHELDON
I know, and I'm sorry. (TO ALTHEA)
We'd like our... contribution back.

ALTHEA

You want me to go back there and bring
you your sperm?

SHELDON

Yes.

ALTHEA

Should I leave it in the cups or do
you want me to see if I have a vase or
maybe a gravy boat?

SHELDON

The cups are fine.

LEONARD USHERS SHELDON OUT THE DOOR.

LEONARD

How is it you can recite pi to eighty
decimal places but you can't recognize
sarcasm?

SHELDON

Oh, I don't think the two are related.

THEY'RE OUT AND WE...

DISSOLVE TO:

COLD OPENING / B

INT. STAIRWELL - LATER THAT DAY (DAY 1)
(Leonard, Sheldon, Penny)

LEONARD AND SHELDON, HOLDING BAGS OF TAKE-OUT INDIAN FOOD,
CLIMB THE FIVE FLIGHTS OF STAIRS THAT LEAD TO THEIR
APARTMENT.

SHELDON
How long are you going to be mad at
me?

LEONARD
I don't know.

SHELDON
Do you see your anger fading gradually
like a radioactive half-life, or
suddenly like a quantum shift: angry,
not angry.

LEONARD
I. Don't. Know.

SHELDON
Well, for the moment it appears to be
holding steady.

THEY CLIMB IN SILENCE FOR A MOMENT.

SHELDON (CONT'D)
Do you want to hear an interesting
thing about stairs?

LEONARD

Not really.

SHELDON

If the height of a single step is off
by as little as two millimeters, most
people will trip.

LEONARD

Two millimeters? That doesn't seem
right.

SHELDON

It's true. I did a series of
experiments when I was twelve. My
father broke his clavicle.

RESET TO:

INT. HALLWAY - CONTINUOUS

THEY HEAD FROM THE STAIRS TO THEIR APARTMENT.

LEONARD

Is that why they sent you to boarding
school?

SHELDON

No, that was a result of my work with
lasers.

SHELDON PUTS THE KEY IN THEIR LOCK, WHEN THEY HEAR...

MUSIC CUE: FUNKY UP TEMPO MUSIC

...FROM A BOOMBOX. THEY TURN AND SEE A BEAUTIFUL GIRL,
PENNY, DANCING WITH RECKLESS ABANDON THROUGH THE OPEN DOORWAY
OF THE APARTMENT ACROSS THE HALL. THEY WATCH FOR A FEW
BEATS, MESMERIZED BY HER RAW SEXUALITY.

LEONARD
New neighbor.

SHELDON
Evidently.

LEONARD
A significant improvement over the old
neighbor.

SHELDON
Assuming one prefers incandescently
attractive women to Harold the old fat
nudist.

LEONARD
May he rest in peace.

THE BOYS WATCH AS PENNY PICKS UP A PHOTOGRAPH OF A HANDSOME
MAN AND SETS IT ON FIRE WITH A LIGHTER. SHE DOESN'T NOTICE
THEM AS SHE CONTINUES TO DANCE.

SHELDON
This might be cause for concern.

LEONARD
Could be a red flag.

PENNY REALIZES THAT SHE'S BEING WATCHED. SHE TURNS OFF THE
MUSIC.

MUSIC CUE: MUSIC OFF

PENNY
(RE: THE PICTURE BURNING IN HER HAND)
Oh my God, I must look totally insane.

LEONARD
Not totally.

SHELDON
Unless this is kindling for a somewhat
larger blaze.

PENNY
(RE: BURNING PHOTO) No, we're just
breaking up. Burning his picture is
symbolic.

SHE SETS IT DOWN IN A TRASH CAN.

LEONARD
You mean like a cleansing, closure
kind of thing?

PENNY
No, my desire to set him on fire.

SHELDON
(TO LEONARD) I'm surprised you missed
that.

PENNY
Penny. New neighbor.

THEY SHAKE HANDS.

LEONARD
Hi, I'm Leonard. This is Sheldon.

SHELDON
(INDICATES THEIR APARTMENT) We're
over here.

PENNY
Cool.